

India-Italy Special Strategic Partnership



For Prelims: Food and Agriculture Organization , India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor , Agricola Medal, European Union

For Mains: India's evolving strategic partnerships with Europe, Significance of the India-Italy Special Strategic Partnership, IMEC and India's connectivity diplomacy

Source:PIB

Why in News?

The Prime Minister of India paid an official visit to **Italy**. During this visit, the two nations officially elevated their **bilateral relations to a Special Strategic Partnership**.

- Additionally, during his visit to Rome, Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with the prestigious **Agricola Medal for 2026** by the **United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** in recognition of his efforts toward global food security and sustainable agriculture.

Summary

- India and Italy elevated their ties to a **Special Strategic Partnership** , expanding cooperation in trade, defence, AI, critical minerals, maritime security, connectivity, and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor to strengthen the emerging Indo-Mediterranean strategic space.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi was also awarded the prestigious Food and Agriculture Organization Agricola Medal 2026 for India's achievements in food security, sustainable agriculture, climate-resilient farming, and digital agricultural innovation.

What are the Key Highlights of the PM's Visit to Italy?

- **Political & Strategic Elevation:** Relations have been upgraded from a Strategic Partnership to a Special Strategic Partnership.

- A new Foreign Ministers-led mechanism will be established to review the **Joint Strategic Action Plan 2025-2029** (adopted at the **G20 Summit held in Rio de Janeiro in November 2024**).
- **Economic Cooperation & Trade Targets:** With the successful conclusion of negotiations for the EU-India Free Trade Agreement, both nations set an ambitious bilateral trade target of **EUR 20 billion by 2029** .
 - Priority sectors include clean technologies, semiconductors, critical minerals, and pharmaceuticals.
- **Defence and Security Collaboration:** A **Defence Industrial Roadmap** was adopted to promote co-development and co-production projects, specifically targeting helicopters, naval platforms, and electronic warfare.
 - Both leaders also agreed to launch a **formal Dialogue on Maritime Security**.
- **Science and Technology:** The leaders announced the creation of **INNOVIT India** , an innovation hub to connect startups, universities, and industries.
 - They also reaffirmed their commitment to human-centric Artificial Intelligence, building on the outcomes of the **AI Impact Summit 2026 held in New Delhi**.
- **Critical Minerals & Energy:** A Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed to establish a structured framework for securing **critical minerals** , with an emphasis on recycling electronic waste.
 - Cooperation will also deepen in **green hydrogen** , smart grids, and renewable energy.
- **Connectivity:** Reaffirmed their commitment to the **India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC)** as a transformative connectivity initiative linking India, the Middle East, and Europe.
 - Both countries emphasized that IMEC would improve trade routes, energy connectivity, logistics, and resilient supply chains while strengthening the emerging “Indo-Mediterranean” strategic space.
- **Migration and Mobility:** Both sides agreed to enhance the mobility of skilled professionals particularly in STEM sectors and nursing through frameworks like the **"ICI - Italy Calls India" talent bridge**.
- **Cultural Exchanges:** The year **2027** will be celebrated as the **"Year of Culture and Tourism between Italy and India."**

Agricola Medal

- **Agricola Medal:** It is the **highest award conferred by the FAO Director-General** upon extraordinary global leaders who exhibit tangible commitment and action toward **eradicating hunger, reducing poverty, and achieving the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.
- **Recognition of Indian Agriculture:** The award highlights India's science-driven agricultural approach.
 - The FAO lauded India's farmer-centric initiatives, specifically highlighting the implementation of the **world's largest food-based social safety net covering 800 million people** and the provisioning of **direct income support to more than 110 million farmers** (via **PM-KISAN**).
 - The award commends India's structural shift toward **regenerative and natural farming**, alongside its global leadership in promoting nutrient-dense, climate-resilient crops, culminating in the **International Year of Millets 2023** celebrated in partnership with the FAO.
 - Key achievements recognized also include the use of **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) in farming**.
- **Alignment with the 'Four Betters' Framework:** India reaffirmed its commitment to the FAO's core operational roadmap aimed at driving agrifood systems transformation: **Better Production, Better Nutrition, Better Environment, and a Better Life**, ensuring no one is left behind.

What is the Significance of Italy for India?

- **Western Anchor of the IMEC:** With the **Red Sea and Suez Canal** facing persistent security volatilities, the IMEC offers a multi-modal alternative.
 - Italy's geographical projection into the **Mediterranean** makes it the logical, and most willing, European entry point for **Indian goods**, energy, and data cables traversing the Middle East.
 - Italy's strategic withdrawal from **China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI)** in late 2023 created a vacuum that India is strategically filling.
 - By anchoring the IMEC, India uses Italy to structurally integrate the **Indo-Pacific with the Mediterranean**, countering Chinese logistical hegemony in Southern Europe.
- **Pillar for Defence Indigenization:** Italy possesses advanced, niche military technologies that are highly complementary to India's **"Make in India"** defense objectives, particularly as India seeks to diversify away from its historical dependence on Russian hardware.
 - Italian defense expertise in radar systems, electronic warfare, and helicopters is crucial for modernizing India's armed forces without the threat of Western sanctions (such as **CAATSA**) that accompany Russian or highly restricted American tech.
- **Geopolitical Leverage Within the EU:** Post-**Brexit**, India requires strong advocates within the EU to navigate Brussels' complex regulatory and trade environments.
 - While France is India's closest strategic partner in Europe, relying solely on Paris is risky. Italy, as the **EU's third-largest economy**, provides New Delhi with a vital balancing weight within the European Parliament and Council, particularly aiding the **India-EU Free Trade Agreement**.
 - Italy's support is crucial for India in pushing back against protectionist EU policies, such as the **Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)**, ensuring that India's industrial exports are not unfairly

penalized.

- **Technological Sovereignty and the Green Transition:** Italy is a global leader in precision manufacturing, robotics, and circular economy practices, aligning perfectly with India's domestic industrial targets.
 - While India lacks domestic reserves of rare earth elements, Italy holds advanced technologies for **extracting critical minerals from electronic waste**.
 - Partnering with Italy allows India to build a resilient, circular supply chain for semiconductors and EVs, mitigating Beijing's monopoly on critical mineral processing.
- **Bridging the Global North and Global South:** Italy's "**Mattei Plan**" seeks a **non-predatory, developmental approach to Africa**.
 - This synergizes with India's extensive developmental footprint (via Digital Public Infrastructure and lines of credit) on the African continent.
 - Together, India and Italy can offer a transparent, capacity-building alternative to African nations burdened by **debt-trap diplomacy of China**.

India-Italy Relations

- **Trade Architecture:** Italy stands as **India's 4th largest trading partner within the European Union (EU)** , with bilateral merchandise trade reaching **USD 13.76 billion in 2024-25** . India consistently maintains a **positive trade balance** (USD 1.70 billion in 2024-25).
- **Foreign Direct Investment (FDI):** Italy ranks **19 th in cumulative FDI inflows to India** (April 2000 – March 2025).
 - The capital inflow is heavily concentrated in the **Automobile sector (29.8%)** , followed by **Trading (17.1%)** and **Industrial Machinery (5.6%)** .
- **Institutionalized Investment Support:** Following high-level forums in early 2025, Italy announced **EUR 470 million in new investments** and established a dedicated **EUR 500 million funding line via SIMEST** (the Italian agency for SME internationalization) by opening its office in Delhi.
- **Strategic Defence and Maritime Convergence:** India shares a deeply rooted military legacy with Italy dating back to the **Italian Campaign of World War II** , where **six Victoria Crosses** were awarded to Indian soldiers out of 20 total decorations.
 - **Maritime and Naval Interoperability:** Bilateral naval coordination features regular **PASSEX (Passing Exercises)** , alongside Italian participation in the **MILAN Naval Exercises** .
- **Science, Technology:** Indian researchers have secured direct access to elite European scientific installations via a Letter of Intent signed with the **Elettra Sincrotrone facility in Trieste, Italy** .
 - Under coordination by **ISRO** and the **Italian Space Agency (ASI)** , the partnership has integrated commercial operations through B2B agreements covering **satellite services and ground station solutions** .
- **Counter-Terrorism & Cyber Security:** Institutional alignment against asymmetric threats includes the launch of the **Inaugural Bilateral Cyber Dialogue** focusing on the protection of **critical information infrastructure** , alongside active coordination within the **Joint Working Group on Counter Terrorism (JWG-CT)** .
- **Geopolitics** : Italy joined several India- led plurilateral initiatives such as **International Solar Alliance (ISA)** , **Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA)**, **Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI)** and **Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative (IPOI)**.

What are the Challenges in India-Italy Relations?

- **Geopolitical Vulnerability** : The physical infrastructure of IMEC remains highly vulnerable to ongoing geopolitical volatility in West Asia.
 - Proxy conflicts, the Red Sea crisis, and threats to maritime choke points (like the Strait of Hormuz) present severe security and financial risks that threaten to delay the operationalization of both the maritime and rail segments of the corridor.
- **Protectionist Policies:** European regulatory frameworks, particularly the **Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)** and strict sanitary and phytosanitary (SPS) measures, disproportionately impact Indian exports (such as steel, textiles, and agricultural products), slowing down true commercial integration.
- **Legacy Compliance:** Both nations suffer from complex, legacy procurement and compliance systems within their respective defense ministries.

- Bureaucratic red tape, rigid technology transfer negotiations, and delays in finalizing joint ventures between Italian defense giants (like Leonardo or Fincantieri) and Indian private/public sector firms often stall active production lines.
- **Differing Frameworks:** Scaling joint ventures in Artificial Intelligence, fintech, and digital public infrastructure requires aligning India's data localization mandates (such as the **Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023**) with Europe's highly stringent **General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)**.
 - Bridging these differing approaches to data sovereignty remains a complex legal hurdle.
- **Financial Burden:** Without a **Social Security Agreement (SSA)** in place, Indian expatriates and professionals working in Italy often face double taxation or lose their pension contributions when they return to India.
 - Reconciling conflicting tax structures and ensuring pension portability takes years of intense negotiation and directly impacts the attractiveness of the Italian labor market for Indian talent.

What Measures can Strengthen India-Italy Relations?

- **Focus on Dual-Use Technologies:** Beyond traditional hardware, the Defence Industrial Roadmap must prioritize joint R&D in emerging domains such as **Quantum Key Distribution (QKD)** for secure naval communications and fiber-optic drone swarms, ensuring interoperability in the Indo-Pacific.
 - Elevate Italy's role from a liaison at the **Information Fusion Centre for Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR)** in Gurugram to a joint developer of autonomous underwater vehicles (AUVs) and anti-submarine warfare (ASW) tech, specifically leveraging Italy's Fincantieri for India's Project 75I.
- **Green Tech Transfer Mechanism:** India and Italy should establish a bilateral framework to facilitate the transfer of Italian decarbonization technologies to Indian MSMEs.
 - This will help Indian exports (especially steel and textiles) remain competitive against the EU's **CBAM**.
- **Data Adequacy Framework:** To operationalise the INNOVIT India hub, the two nations must negotiate a "data equivalence" pact that bridges the compliance gap between India's **DPDP Act** and the EU's strict **GDPR**, enabling seamless cross-border data flows for AI and fintech startups.
 - India and Italy must co-author global governance frameworks for AI ("Algor-ethics") to ensure that emerging regulatory architectures (like the EU AI Act) do not stifle the developmental needs of the Global South.
- **Expediting the Social Security Agreement (SSA):** Finalizing **SSA** agreement is critical to exempting Indian STEM professionals and nurses from double taxation and ensuring the portability of their pension benefits, thereby legally securing the talent pipeline.

Conclusion

The India-Italy Special Strategic Partnership marks a decisive shift in bilateral relations from traditional diplomacy to a multidimensional strategic alliance. With cooperation spanning defence, trade, AI, energy, maritime security, and connectivity, both nations are positioning themselves as key partners in shaping an emerging Indo-Mediterranean order.

Drishti Mains Question:

India and Italy have upgraded their relationship to a Special Strategic Partnership. Discuss the strategic, economic, and geopolitical significance of this move.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the main outcome of PM Modi's visit to Italy?

India and Italy upgraded their relationship to a **Special Strategic Partnership**, with new commitments in trade, defence, connectivity, AI, and critical minerals.

2. Why is IMEC important for India-Italy relations?

IMEC strengthens trade, logistics, energy links, and resilient supply chains between India, the Middle East, and Europe, with Italy acting as a key European gateway.

3. What is the Defence Industrial Roadmap?

It is a framework for **co-development and co-production** in defence sectors such as helicopters, naval platforms, and electronic warfare, supporting India's defence indigenization.

4. Why was PM Modi awarded the FAO Agricola Medal?

He received it for leadership in **food security, sustainable agriculture, and rural development**, especially India's science-driven and climate-resilient farming model.

[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/gHT7IWvP8co](https://www.youtube.com/embed/gHT7IWvP8co)]

UPSC Civil Services Examination Previous Year's Question (PYQs)

Prelims:

Q. Consider the following statements: (2023)

1. The 'Stability and Growth Pact' of the European Union is a treaty that
2. limits the levels of the budgetary deficit of the countries of the European Union
3. makes the countries of the European Union to share their infrastructure facilities
4. enables the countries of the European Union to share their technologies

How many of the above statements are correct

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All three
- (d) None

Exp: (a)

Mains

Q. Indian diaspora has a decisive role to play in the politics and economy of America and European Countries'. Comment with examples. **(2020)**

Sperm Whale



Source: TH

A recent *Proceedings of the Royal Society B* study found that sperm whale communication is more complex than earlier understood, with sound categories, timing, and sequencing rules resembling human phonology.

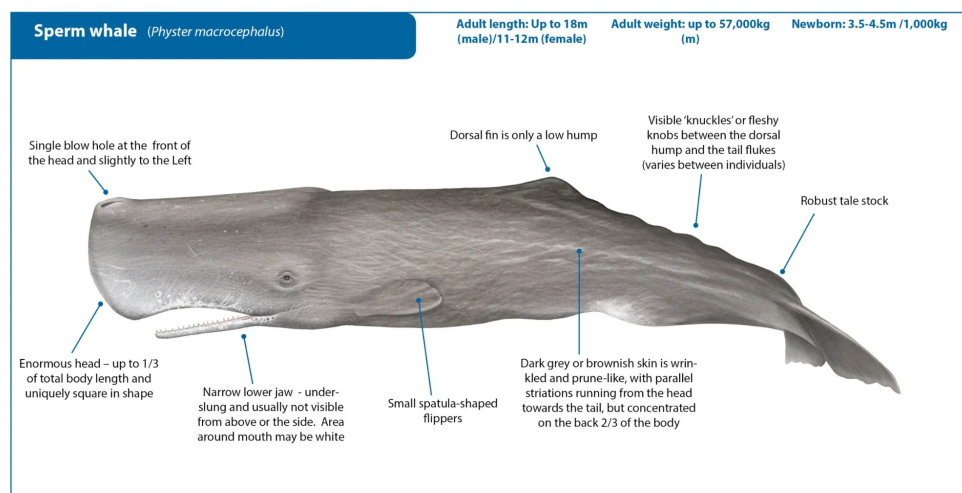
- It suggests that humans and sperm whales may have independently evolved complex vocal systems due to their advanced social behaviour.

Sperm Whales

- **About:** Sperm whales are the **largest toothed whales**, generally dark grey to brownish in colour, with

some individuals having white patches on the belly.

- They have an **extremely large head**, making up nearly one-third of their body length, and are the **only living cetaceans** with a single blowhole placed asymmetrically on the left side of the head.
- They are named after **spermaceti, a waxy oil sac** in their heads that helps focus sound, and they possess the largest brain of any animal.
- **Diet:** Sperm whales feed mainly on deep-sea species such as **squid, sharks, skates and fish**, consuming around 3 to 3.5% of their body weight daily.
- **Reproduction & Growth:** Female sperm whales mature around **9 years of age**, give birth to a single calf after a **14-16 month gestation period**, and reproduce once every **5-7 years**.
 - Male sperm whales grow **much larger than females, mature physically around 50 years**, and usually begin active breeding **only in their late twenties**.
 - Females live in **stable family-based social units in tropical waters, while young males leave** to form **bachelor pods, and older males** often migrate toward polar regions or live alone.
- **Distribution:** Sperm whales have **one of the widest global distributions** among marine mammals, inhabiting deep oceans from the equator to the edges of **Arctic and Antarctic pack ice**.
 - Their distribution and migration depend on **food availability, breeding conditions, sex and age**, with adult males often migrating to temperate waters while females and young usually remain in tropical waters year-round.
- **Conservation Status:**
 - **IUCN:** Vulnerable
 - **CITES:** Appendix I
 - **Convention on Migratory Species (CMS):** Appendix I
 - **Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972** : Schedule I
- **Threats:** Major threats include vessel strikes, entanglement in fishing gear, ocean noise, marine debris, and climate-driven changes in habitat and food availability.



Read more: [Sperm Whales](#)

Gaganyaan's Environmental Control and Life Support System



Source: TH

Indian Space Research Organisation Gaganyaan Mission aims to send Indian astronauts into a 400-km low Earth orbit. To ensure astronaut survival in space, the spacecraft is equipped with an advanced **Environmental Control and Life Support System (ECLSS)** that recreates Earth-like living conditions by regulating air, water, pressure, temperature, humidity, and waste management in a microgravity environment.

- Gaganyaan is a **short-duration mission** , so supplies like oxygen and water are carried from Earth and waste is stored for disposal later. Long-duration missions recycle waste into breathable air and clean water.

Core Subsystems of an ECLSS

- **Air Revitalisation:** The **Air Revitalisation System (ARS)** supplies fresh oxygen and actively removes exhaled carbon dioxide using **lithium hydroxide canisters with activated charcoal** .
 - Small ECLSS fans circulate air to prevent lethal **pockets of CO₂ and oxygen** from forming due to the lack of natural convection in microgravity.
- **Thermal and Humidity Regulation:** The cabin maintains a strict temperature of **20-26°C and 30-70% humidity** .
 - Active cooling systems use **heat exchangers to expel metabolic and electronic heat into space** , while condensing units manage moisture to prevent short-circuits and microbial growth.
- **Atmospheric Pressure:** The cabin pressure is strictly maintained at **101.3 kilopascal (kPa) to mimic Earth's sea-level conditions** , utilizing electronic sensors and safety valves to balance breathable gas levels.
- **Water Management:** Due to microgravity, water forms floating **globules** that threaten electronics and pose inhalation hazards.
 - Gaganyaan utilizes **pressurized bladders** to mechanically force potable water from specially designed pouches directly to the astronauts.
- **Waste Disposal:** Microgravity necessitates **suction-based airflow systems** to manage human waste, preventing it from floating.
 - Faeces and urine are collected, **chemically treated to inhibit bacterial growth and toxic ammonia buildup** , and stored in sealed containers for Earth disposal.
- **Fire Suppression:** Since microgravity causes fires to expand spherically, Gaganyaan uses **smoke detectors and fine water mist fire extinguishers** , which effectively cool the fire while simultaneously scrubbing toxic smoke particles from the cabin air.

THE GAGANYAAN

Estimated cost:

₹90 billion



OBJECTIVE:

Demonstration of human spaceflight capability by launching crew members into an orbit of 400 km for a three-day mission and bringing them back safely to earth.

The launch of the mission will be done aboard the LVM3 rocket.



According to reports, **the four astronauts underwent comprehensive training at Russia's Yuri Gagarin Cosmonaut Training Center** and an ISRO established Astronaut Training Facility in Bengaluru.



If it succeeds, **India will become only the fourth country to send a human into space** after the Soviet Union, the US and China.

Read more: [DRDO Conducts Gaganyaan's Drogue Parachute Test](#)

Birth Anniversary of Pandit Iyothee Thass



Source: TH

Recently, Tamil Nadu's Chief Minister paid floral tributes to **Pandit Iyothee Thass** on his **181 st birth anniversary** .

Pandit Iyothee Thass

- **About:** Pandit Iyothee Thass was a prominent **social reformer, thinker, anti-caste activist and pioneer of the Dalit Buddhist movement in South India** .
- **Birth:** He was born on **20 th May 1845** in **Thousand Lights, Madras** , in the Madras Presidency

during British rule.

- **Anti-Caste Movement:** He worked extensively against **caste discrimination and untouchability** , advocating dignity and equal rights for oppressed communities.
- **Buddhist Revival:** He argued that oppressed castes were originally Buddhists and promoted the **revival of Buddhism among Dalits** in Tamil society.
- **Organisations:** As a young reformer, he organised the Depressed Classes through the **Advaidananda Sabha** , which opposed religious conversion pressures and explored Advaitic ideas to challenge caste discrimination.
 - He later led the **Dravida Mahajana Sabha** in 1891 and established the **Sakya Buddhist Society** in Madras in 1898, strengthening social awareness, anti-caste mobilisation and Buddhist revival among oppressed communities.
- **Census Demand:** In the context of the **1881 Census**, he demanded that **oppressed and outcaste communities** be identified as **Original Tamils** rather than classified as Hindus.
- **Journalism:** He launched the Tamil journal **Oru Paisa Tamizhan** in 1907, later renamed **Tamilan** , as a key platform for social reform and anti-caste discourse.
- **Significance:** He is regarded as one of the earliest voices of **social justice, self-respect and Dalit assertion in modern India** .



Read more: [Buddhism in India](#)

India's Abstention on UNGA Climate Resolution



Source:TH

India abstained from voting on a **United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) resolution** that calls on states to **comply with climate change obligations** based on an advisory **opinion of the International Court of Justice (ICJ)**.

- **Voting Outcome:** The resolution, originally moved by the **Pacific island nation of Vanuatu**, was adopted by the **193-member UNGA** with **141 votes in favor, 8 against (including the US and Russia), and 28 abstentions (including India)** .
- **ICJ Advisory Opinion on Climate Change:** Ruled that countries have an explicit **legal obligation to combat anthropogenic climate change** and protect environmental systems for both present and future generations .
 - The ICJ ruled that a **state's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs)** fall under the **principle of due diligence**. Countries must exercise strict administrative enforcement and ensure their climate goals represent their **"highest possible ambition"**.
- **Legal Status of the Opinion:** While an **ICJ advisory opinion is non-binding**, it carries substantial "legal weight and moral authority" that will shape the evolution of customary international environmental law and domestic climate litigation globally.

Key Reasons Behind India's Abstention

- **Defending the UNFCCC's "Sacrosanct Architecture":** India expressed serious concern that the resolution attempts to elevate a **non-binding ICJ advisory opinion to a binding or quasi-binding status**.
 - India asserted that its climate obligations arise **solely from outcomes negotiated under the UNFCCC** , not from judicial mandates.
- **Protecting NDCs:** The resolution prescribes specific mitigation pathways and external benchmarks.
 - India argued that this threatens the **bottom-up, nationally determined architecture of the Paris Agreement** and exposes domestic climate targets (NDCs) to international judicial or quasi-judicial scrutiny.
- **Glaring Omission of Climate Finance:** India strongly objected to the complete absence of the term **"climate finance"** in the text.
 - India's representative termed it a **"serious omission,"** highlighting that the resolution imposes sweeping obligations without reaffirming the fundamental duty of developed countries to provide predictable financing, technology transfer, and capacity building.
- **Dilution of CBDR-RC & Just Transition:** The draft failed to adequately distinguish the responsibilities of historical emitters from developing economies.
 - India reiterated the core principle of **Common But Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC)** , insisting that any energy transition must be **just, orderly, and equitable** , ensuring it does not derail poverty eradication and economic growth in the Global

South.

- **Solidarity with Small Island Developing States (SIDS):** Despite these foundational disagreements, India deliberately chose to **abstain rather than vote against** the resolution (unlike the US or Russia).
 - This move signaled India's continued solidarity with the existential climate vulnerabilities and "historical injustice" faced by SIDS like Vanuatu.



The Jurisdiction of the International Court of Justice (ICJ)



The ICJ is a permanent international court created in 1945 by the United Nations Charter as "the principal judicial organ of the United Nations."



The ICJ's functions are set out in the Statute of the ICJ—an annex to and "an integral part" of the UN Charter.



The ICJ was created to provide a peaceful means for resolving disputes.



Only states, and not government officials or other individuals, may be parties in cases before the ICJ. Some UN bodies may also appear before the ICJ to seek its opinion.

Two Types of ICJ Case Jurisdiction

1. Contentious Jurisdiction

Jurisdiction to Decide Disputes Between States

All states that are parties to the case must consent to the ICJ's jurisdiction in one of **three** ways:

i Consent to Compulsory Jurisdiction

A state may consent to the compulsory jurisdiction of the ICJ to resolve disputes with another state accepting the same obligation. The United States consented in 1946 but withdrew from the ICJ's compulsory jurisdiction in 1985.

ii Consent to Jurisdiction in a Treaty

A state may consent to jurisdiction by including a specific clause in a treaty known as a compromissory clause. Most of the cases involving the United States have been based on compromissory clauses setting forth the terms for all future disputes related to the treaty.

iii Consent to Jurisdiction Over a Specific Dispute

A state may consent to jurisdiction via a special agreement reached between the parties to resolve a particular dispute after it has occurred. For example, in 1981, the United States and Canada entered into a special agreement regarding a maritime boundary.

2. Advisory Jurisdiction

Jurisdiction to Answer a Question of International Law

The ICJ has jurisdiction to decide questions of international law that are submitted by:

i The UN Security Council

The Security Council, which has "primary responsibility for the maintenance of international peace and security," may request an advisory opinion on any legal question. The United States is a permanent member of the Council.

ii The UN General Assembly

The General Assembly, which is the "main policy-making organ" of the UN, may request an advisory opinion on any legal question. The United States is a member of the General Assembly.

iii Another U.N. body or specialized agencies

The UN Charter provides that "[o]ther organs of the United Nations and specialized agencies . . . may also request advisory opinions of the Court on legal questions arising within the scope of their activities." An example is the International Fund for Agricultural Development, of which the United States is a member.

The Effect and Enforcement of ICJ Decisions

- The UN Charter requires parties to **contentious cases** to comply with judgments.
- If a state does not comply, an opposing state party in the case may request enforcement by the Security Council.

Advisory opinions are nonbinding.

The ICJ's opinions in all cases can contribute to the development of international law and are generally considered to be authoritative by many states and the international community more broadly.

ICJ in Practice: Examples from the Court's Docket

Nicaragua v. Germany

In March 2024, Nicaragua filed a case against Germany alleging that Germany's provision of arms to Israel for use in its military campaign in Gaza violates:

1. international humanitarian law as codified in the Geneva Conventions, and
2. the Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of Genocide (Genocide Convention).

Nicaragua invoked two bases of the ICJ's contentious-case jurisdiction:

1. compulsory jurisdiction, which Nicaragua and Germany had accepted; and
2. jurisdiction under the compromissory clause of the Genocide Convention. (Article IX)

Obligations of States in respect of Climate Change

In April 2023, the General Assembly requested an advisory opinion on the international legal obligations related to climate change. Ninety-one states and entities filed statements on the matter, the highest number to have been filed in an advisory proceeding.

In July 2025, the ICJ issued its opinion. The ICJ concluded that states have certain obligations to protect the climate system under various sources of international law and may be responsible for a failure to meet those obligations.

Read more: [ICJ's Advisory on State Duties for Climate Action](#)

Mission Arunachal Kiwi



Source: PIB

Recently, the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER) launched the **Mission on “Arunachal Kiwi: The Unique Selling Proposition of Arunachal Pradesh”** to promote Arunachal Pradesh as India’s premium organic kiwi hub under the **Viksit North East vision**.

- **About:** The Mission has an outlay of around ₹167 crore, follows a **whole-of-government, convergence-led model** anchored by the MDoNER and supported by key ministries, institutions and private investors.
 - The mission forms part of the broader **“One State-One USP” approach** , including products such as **Lakadong Turmeric (Meghalaya), Coffee (Nagaland), Ginger (Mizoram) and Muga Silk (Assam)** .
- **Objectives:** The mission aims to address key gaps such as **low farmer prices, distress sales, weak cold-chain infrastructure** , lapsed **National Programme for Organic Production certification**, poor branding and limited export linkages.
- **Cluster-Based Model:** The programme adopts a **cluster-based approach with six integrated post-harvest management hubs** across **Ziro Valley, Dirang, Kalaktang, Shi Yomi and Dibang Valley** .
- **Strategic Pillars:** Its four strategic pillars are **convergence, value addition, branding and market integration**, with targets such as 2,000 metric tonnes cold-chain capacity, improved processing and higher farmer income.
- **Market Opportunity:** Arunachal’s **November-January harvest season coincides with New Zealand’s off-season** , creating export opportunities in **South-East Asia, Europe and the Middle East** . Arunachal Pradesh produces over 50% of India’s kiwi output and was the 1st state to receive organic kiwi certification.
- **Significance:** The initiative aims to **reduce post-harvest losses, increase farmer income, strengthen organic agriculture and position “Arunachal Organic Kiwi” in premium global markets** .

Read more: [Northeast India From Frontier to Frontrunner](#)